



Photoshop 1.0 was released as an application only for the Mac

Canon

Canon Edge (www.canon-edge.com) is a community site started for Canon camera users

TRIED & TESTED

The autofocus works exceptionally well and is very quick. Similar focussing options are present on even the cheaper Canon dSLRs. We received the Canon EOS 50D with a standard 18-55mm lens. The quality of lens is good, but it's not optimal for outdoor shooting of large areas. On the other hand, for macros with zoom engaged, it's possible to get good up-close photos. The manual focus is also very good and you can get accurate focus on small objects.

The camera has a good burst shooting mode and it performs well for a second or two, but after that the shots slow down. We used a SanDisk Extreme III CompactFlash card for these tests. The flash isn't strong or as impressive as the rest of the camera.

The EOS 50D is clearly an exciting piece of equipment. The overall results are stunning, but there are a couple of complaints — the biggest one being the ON / OFF switch being at the bottom, and a complete pain to use. It's too tiny and is flimsy in comparison to all the other controls on the camera. For its feel, ergonomics, performance and features, this makes a strong contender for the best camera in this test. The price for this camera, with lens, is Rs. 81,995.

Nikon D60

The Nikon D60 falls into the entry-level dSLR bracket. This category has been bubbling with activity with manufacturers trying hard to get the attention of eager enthusiasts who might take the leap. Like the rest of the contenders in that price range, the D60 is a 10.2 MP camera.

The biggest and the most prominent feature about the D60 is the usability of the functionality. Nikon has done a lot to ensure that the user is never lost in a sea of options. All of the features and options are clearly distinguished and a dedicated help button gives a short description of each of the feature's details. The menus are very warm and the main interface displaying the aperture size, shutter speeds and all the settings is highly interactive and animated. All this user-friendliness does not



Nikon D60



make the camera feel very bare and toned down — it still has an edge over the other dSLRs in the same price range.

Holding it is as difficult as with the other small dSLRs. The body is close to the hand grip with just enough space for your fingers. However, the build is superior to the Canon EOS 1000D, 400D and the Sony A200.

Images turned out well and the Auto shoot mode does its part nicely. The noise at ISO 1600 is very manageable and is on a par with the EOS 1000D and the 400D. Nikon supplies a good 18-55 mm VR lens, which makes a big difference. The VR works pretty well, but a lens of this calibre doesn't really need it.

At the end of the evaluation, it's the D60 that seems to be preferred; and rightly so, for its ease of use, it features excellent menus and has a user-friendly design. It feels very much like a refined camera than an attempt to tone everything down too much for the sake of ease of use.

Nikon D80

The Nikon D80 is actually a camera from late 2006. The D90 was released last year and the general reaction everywhere was to show the thumbs-up. The D80 was known to be a good camera. It made good sense as a dSLR for a casual photography enthusiast. We were interested in the D80 primarily for its lower pricing with the D90 now in the market.

The controls and body construction of the D80 are similar to those of the D90. The directional buttons aren't very large, though. A two-jog dial setup is present on the D80 and is a welcomed feature any day. Changing shutter speed and aperture size simultaneously with them makes life easier, for sure. Controls for the white balance and ISO are lined along the left of the screen, so operating the camera settings requires using both your hands at times.

The smaller screen is present on top which immediately takes it a step up from the entry-level dSLRs. This feature makes adjusting settings much more straightforward. There's no need to look at the screen and use the directional keys to change any of the settings. Taking photos while making adjustments simultaneously is a lot simpler this way. This is a feature only found on mid-ranged dSLRs. The other difference is the eyepiece which is larger than with other cameras. Focussing automatically becomes simpler. There's also support for a remote-control which is a nice function that can be useful when taking long exposure shots on a tripod.

One of the annoyances of the D80 has to be the tiny direction buttons all combined together. This is hard to use and is similar to the control used in the much older D70.



Nikon D80

The D80 supports a larger battery pack; this gives more power to the camera and also makes it easier to hold. The battery pack can hold two D80 batteries. Like the D90, the D80 also uses SD/SDHC cards for storing images.

The lens we received with the camera was Nikon's AF-S 18-135 mm. It's the most powerful lens of the ones in this test. This wasn't a VR, but it didn't affect us a lot while taking telephoto shots.

Another addition with cameras such as the D80 is the more comprehensive menu system. Control for many more of the features can be found and each one modified according to your needs.

While the D80 is pretty identical to the D90 on most fronts, the larger and better quality screen is the biggest difference, we feel. Liveview and video recording are the other very important additions to the D90. With a price tag of Rs. 70,950 including the AF-S DX 18-135/3.5-5.6G lens, the D80 is slightly cheaper than the D90.

Nikon D90

Nikon's D90 is one of the newest entries to Nikon's line-up. The D80 was known for its really great quality sensor and the D40X was another camera that used it. The D80 was previously known as a great mid-range dSLR. The D90 therefore has a lot to prove, especially as it is quite costly.

The biggest difference going from a D40X or any other entry-level dSLR is the sheer size. It's more or less the same as the D80. The D90 we received for review from Nikon came with an 18-105-mm VR lens. Its functions and this kind of range lets the user to capture from wide-angle images to good telescopic images (for better telescopic images, you would consider the Nikon 18-200 mm lens.). This lens could be described as having a 6x optical zoom. As an overall solution, this lens with the D90 body makes an excellent choice.

Operating the D90 is pretty straightforward, although it isn't as simple as the D60 or the D40X. There isn't the help menu